

27/09/2025

Parried, Catch-22, Flicked, Brandish, Ousted

1. Parried (पैर किया / टाल दिया) (Verb) ('per-id) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** To ward off or deflect a physical or verbal attack.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी हमले (शारीरिक या मौखिक) को रोकना या टालना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *parare* → **Middle French** *parer* → English *parry*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Deflected, Fended off
 - **Antonym:** Accepted, Received
- **Connotation:** Neutral, often strategic or skillful in context
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A fencer skillfully deflects an opponent's thrust with a quick move.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Politicians often parried tough questions from reporters during press conferences. By redirecting the conversation or providing vague answers, they avoid directly addressing controversial issues. Similarly, managers parry criticism from employees by highlighting positive results, ensuring smooth communication. In personal relationships, individuals

may parry sensitive topics with humor or tact. The act of parrying requires awareness, timing, and strategy, whether in verbal, physical, or metaphorical contexts. By mastering the art of parrying, one can navigate challenges without direct confrontation, preserving harmony and minimizing conflict.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- **Correct:** He parried the question with a clever reply. (उसने सवाल का जवाब चतुराई से टाल दिया।)
- **Incorrect:** He parried the ball into the goal. (उसने गेंद को गोल में पैर किया। (*misuse of context*))

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When faced with criticism or difficult questions, mentally “parry” before responding. Delay, deflect, or redirect for strategic advantage. This can prevent impulsive replies and create space for thoughtful, controlled responses. Think of conversation like fencing—timing is everything.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- She parried his accusations with calm reasoning. (उसने उसके आरोपों को शांतिपूर्ण तर्क से टाल दिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): parried
 - O (Object): his accusations
 - + (Adverbial Phrase of Manner): with calm reasoning

- **Common Collocations:**

- parry a blow, parry a question, parry criticism

- **My Statement:**

- The politician parried several critical questions in the interview.
- The popular actor parried criticism from critics with the help of a solid PR team.
- The soldier parried the enemy’s attack with proven military techniques.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

2. Catch-22 (कैच-22) (Noun) (kætʃ 'twenti: tu:) (Neutral/Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** A dilemma or paradoxical situation where no solution is possible.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** ऐसी स्थिति जहाँ कोई समाधान असंभव हो।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - From Joseph Heller's novel *Catch-22* (1961) → **idiomatic usage**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Dilemma, Paradox
 - **Antonym:** Opportunity, Solution
- **Connotation:** Negative, frustrating
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A job applicant cannot get experience without a job, and cannot get a job without experience.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Catch-22 situations arise frequently in bureaucracy, where regulations contradict each other. For instance, a bank may require a credit history to grant a loan, but the individual cannot build a credit history without access to credit. Similarly, in corporate hiring, a fresh graduate faces a catch-22 when every role demands prior experience. These situations highlight systemic flaws and the frustration of individuals trapped in them. Understanding

catch-22s can help one navigate complex systems strategically, either by finding loopholes, leveraging networks, or challenging rigid rules creatively.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- **Correct:** It's a real catch-22; you can't get a job without experience, and you can't get experience without a job. (यह एक सच्चा कैच-22 है; आप अनुभव के बिना नौकरी नहीं पा सकते, और नौकरी के बिना अनुभव नहीं पा सकते।)
- **Incorrect:** He solved the catch-22 easily. (उसने कैच-22 को आसानी से हल किया। (*misuse: implies easy resolution*))

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When stuck in a paradoxical problem, label it mentally as a “catch-22.” Recognizing its nature reduces frustration. Focus on alternative approaches, think laterally, or accept constraints strategically. Awareness is the first step to navigating impossible-seeming dilemmas.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- Applying for a loan without collateral is a catch-22. (गारंटी के बिना ऋण के लिए आवेदन करना एक कैच-22 है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): Applying for a loan without collateral
 - V (Verb – Linking): is
 - O (Subject Complement – Predicate Noun): a catch-22

- **Common Collocations:**

- face a catch-22, catch-22 situation, create a catch-22

- **My Statement:**

- The solution to a catch-22 is hard to derive.
- In a catch-22 situation, one may feel trapped.
- I faced a catch-22 at the start of my career.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

3. Flicked (छिड़का / झटका) (Verb) (flikt) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** To make a sudden, quick movement, usually with the fingers or hand.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** अचानक झटका देना या झटके से करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *flician* → **Middle English *flicken*** → English *flick*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Snapped, Flipped
 - **Antonym:** Dropped, Placed gently
- **Connotation:** Neutral, often casual or playful
- **Pictorial Scenario:** He flicked the switch to turn on the light.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In daily life, flicking is an automatic response: flicking a switch, flicking dust off a surface, or flicking a page in a book. These quick motions are efficient and save time. In behavioral studies, flicking gestures can signal irritation, playfulness, or decision-making. Understanding subtle physical cues like flicking can help interpret intentions and emotions. Sports coaching often emphasizes the flicking motion for precision in actions

like table tennis or wrist shots in hockey, showing how small, controlled movements have functional and strategic significance.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** She flicked the crumbs off the table. (उसने मेज से टुकड़े झटक दिए।)
- **Incorrect:** She flicked the book across the room. (उसने किताब को कमरे में झटका दिया। (*misuse: implies improper forceful movement*))

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Flick small, unnecessary things off your workspace or mind to maintain clarity. Quick, deliberate flicks—whether physical or mental—prevent clutter from building up. Think micro-actions: small, fast, and purposeful.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- He flicked the switch and the light turned on. (उसने स्विच को झटका दिया और लाइट चालू हो गई।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **Clause 1**
 - S (Subject): He
 - V (Verb – Transitive): flicked
 - O (Object): the switch
 - **Clause 2 (Coordinated with “and”)**
 - S (Subject): the light
 - V (Verb – Intransitive): turned on
 - O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive phrasal verb)

- **Common Collocations:**

- flick a switch, flick a page, flick crumbs, flick hair

- **My Statement:**

- He flicked his arms quickly when an insect crawled into his shirt.
- After a bath, she flicked her hair to get rid of water droplets.
- The page was flicked to test its durability.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

4. Brandish (लहराना / घुमाना) (Verb) ('brændiʃ) (Neutral/Threatening)

- **Meaning (English):** To wave or flourish something, especially a weapon, in a threatening or triumphant way.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी चीज़ को, विशेषकर हथियार, धमकी या गर्व से लहराना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old French *brandir* → **English *brandish***
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Wave, Flourish
 - **Antonym:** Conceal, Lower
- **Connotation:** Slightly aggressive or showy
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A knight brandishing his sword before battle.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In political debates, candidates may metaphorically brandish statistics or reports to assert authority. In history, armies brandished flags to signal aggression or unity. Brandishing carries an implication of display and intimidation, often with power dynamics. In literature, brandishing a weapon often precedes action or a tense moment. Recognizing when someone brandishes ideas, tools, or authority can help interpret intent and respond appropriately. The action is both literal and figurative, emphasizing

the performative aspect of presenting something to influence perception, evoke fear, or inspire confidence.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** He brandished the sword before the duel. (उसने द्वंद्वयुद्ध से पहले तलवार लहराई।)
- **Incorrect:** He brandished quietly in the corner. (उसने कोने में चुपचाप लहराया।
(*misuse: brandish implies noticeable action*))

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When asserting authority, mentally brandish key facts or evidence. Present them clearly and confidently, like a sword in hand. Visibility and clarity amplify impact, ensuring your point is noticed without overextending. Think of influence as controlled display, not random waving.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- She brandished the certificate proudly. (उसने प्रमाणपत्र गर्व से लहराया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): brandished
 - O (Object): the certificate
 - + (Adverbial of Manner): proudly

- **Common Collocations:**

- brandish a sword, brandish a weapon, brandish evidence, brandish authority

- **My Statement:**

- The army brandished the weapons in the annual parade.
- The lawyer brandished documents confidently in court.
- He brandished his authority through words at those who were criticizing them.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

5. Ousted (हटाया गया / निष्कासित) (Verb, Past Participle) ('aʊstɪd) (Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Removed from a position of power or authority.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** सत्ता या पद से हटाया गया।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *ex-* + Old French *oster* → **English *oust***
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Deposed, Removed
 - **Antonym:** Installed, Appointed
- **Connotation:** Negative, often forceful or political
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A CEO being forced to step down amid scandal.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Political and corporate worlds frequently see leaders ousted due to scandals, failures, or shifts in power. Shareholders may oust board members who fail to meet expectations. Countries witness leaders ousted via coups, votes of no confidence, or elections. Understanding the dynamics of ousting provides insight into power structures and accountability. The act usually signals disapproval, a change in direction, or loss of influence. For professionals, learning from those ousted can guide strategic decisions,

emphasizing the importance of transparency, performance, and stakeholder management to avoid sudden removal from positions of responsibility.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** The CEO was ousted after the scandal. (कांड के बाद CEO को पद से हटा दिया गया।)
- **Incorrect:** He ousted the book from the shelf. (उसने किताब को शेल्फ से हटाया। (*misuse: informal object*))

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Track positions of influence around you. Understand who could be ousted and why. Anticipating structural vulnerabilities sharpens strategic thinking. Learn from ousted figures to strengthen your position and avoid pitfalls. Knowledge of power dynamics is as important as skill or effort.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- The politician was ousted from office after corruption charges. (भ्रष्टाचार के आरोपों के बाद राजनेता को पद से हटाया गया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The politician
 - V (Verb – Passive, Transitive): was ousted
 - O (Object): — (None explicit; implied object = “him/her”)
 - + (Adverbial of Place): from office
 - + (Adverbial Clause of Reason): after corruption charges

- **Common Collocations:**

- ousted from power, ousted from office, ousted leader, ousted official

- **My Statement:**

- The original owner of the company was ousted by the stakeholders.
- She was ousted from office for her extremely rude behavior.
- The leaders of the nation were ousted from their positions for corruption.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]